

UX REPORT: COURSERA

GROUP: LATE TO THE PARTY

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IMY 320 GROUP DESIGN B

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1. Introduction

Coursera (<https://www.coursera.org>) is an online learning platform that hosts courses, professional certificates, and degrees from universities and industry partners. For this evaluation, participants used Coursera's Explore flow: selecting a field of study and browsing all courses linked to that field, including opening individual courses to view more detail. Coursera was chosen as a reference point because it is a large, established e learning platform whose course browsing conventions are likely to shape what users expect from any similar catalogue. This evaluation feeds directly into the brief: understanding how an existing, well used platform handles course discovery before redesigning CodeCampus's own catalogue as a list based layout (per the client's explicit rejection of a cell/grid layout) in line with Fitts's Law.

2. Methodology

A shortened UEQ (User Experience Questionnaire) was used to gather quick, comparable impressions of the course discovery experience.

Participants: 3 participants, P1 (age 21), P2 (age 26), and P3 (age 23). All had prior experience with online learning platforms.

Procedure:

- Open the website.
- Click Explore and select a field of interest.
- Browse all courses linked to that field, opening courses to view more detail as desired.
- Return to the form and answer the questions.

Pages evaluated: A single combined experience covering course discovery, the catalogue browse flow together with course detail viewing. Note that unlike the Group A evaluations, this survey did not score the Course Catalogue and Course Detail page separately; participants rated the combined "explore and browse" experience as one flow.

Scale: 7 point semantic differential across 5 criteria:

- Boring to Exciting
- Conventional to Innovative
- Usual to Modern
- Inefficient to Efficient
- Not Interesting to Interesting

3. Participant Overview

Participant	Age
P1	21

Participant	Age
P2	26
P3	23

4. UEQ Results

4.1 Course Catalogue & Detail (combined browse experience)

Criterion	P1	P2	P3	Average
Boring to Exciting	6	6	4	5.3
Conventional to Innovative	6	7	3	5.3
Usual to Modern	4	7	4	5.0
Inefficient to Efficient	4	5	5	4.7
Not Interesting to Interesting	6	6	5	5.7

5. Findings & Discussion

The highest score overall was Not Interesting to Interesting (5.7), suggesting Coursera's course catalogue succeeds at pulling users in and holding their attention while browsing a field of study. The lowest score was Inefficient to Efficient (4.7), the weakest dimension of the whole evaluation.

The Conventional to Innovative and Usual to Modern criteria also show the widest spread between participants of any criteria in this evaluation (Innovative ranged from 3 to 7, Modern ranged from 4 to 7). This split matters because it suggests Coursera's grid/cell based catalogue lands very differently depending on the user. Some found it fresh and current, others found it plain or dated. A layout that produces this much disagreement is a weaker foundation to imitate than one that scores consistently.

The UEQ scale used here does not directly measure target size, spacing, or click precision, so it cannot confirm a Fitts's Law problem on its own. That said, the low Efficient score is consistent with a common friction point in cell/grid catalogues: course cards pack many small, closely spaced click targets (thumbnail, title, rating, provider) into one card, which increases the risk of mis-clicks and slows task completion. This is exactly the kind of friction Fitts's Law predicts when targets are small and closely packed, and it lines up with the client's own complaint about "cells" and their explicit request for a list layout instead.

Because this survey combined catalogue browsing and course detail viewing into a single rated experience, these findings describe the discovery journey as a whole rather than isolating which specific screen (catalogue vs. detail) drove the Efficient score down. This is a limitation of the data collected and should be noted when the group compiles the shared findings document.

6. Design Guidelines Derived

- Replace the cell/grid catalogue with a list layout, per the client's explicit brief, giving each course a single large clickable row rather than several small competing targets packed into one card. This directly addresses Fitts's Law by increasing effective target size and reducing the number of adjacent targets a user must aim between.
- Make each list row's entire clickable area large and unambiguous (the full row, not just the title text), since Fitts's Law states that larger, closer targets are faster and more accurate to select.
- Keep sort and search controls large, clearly labelled, and positioned consistently at the top of the list, since these are the client's explicitly requested list features and will be used repeatedly.
- Avoid replicating the inconsistency seen in the Innovative/Modern scores. Aim for a layout that reads as clearly and consistently useful rather than one that some users find modern and others find plain.
- Preserve the ability to access more detail on a course (the client wants access to the description) via a clear, appropriately sized action within each list row, rather than requiring a separate small "view more" icon.

7. Conclusion

The Coursera evaluation shows a course discovery experience that is engaging and holds interest, but is held back by lower perceived efficiency and inconsistent impressions of how modern or innovative the layout feels. Given that cell based grids are a plausible contributor to that efficiency gap, and given the client's explicit preference for a traditional list, this evaluation supports the group's move toward a list based catalogue layout that maximises clickable target size and consistency, directly applying Fitts's Law to the CodeCampus redesign.